

Section B – Media Language and Representation

Section B focuses on media language and representation and requires learners to consider how and why media language is used by media producers to create meaning and construct various representations of events, issues, individuals and

social groups.

In this section, learners are required to study the following media forms and products set by OCR.

Media Forms	Advertising and Marketing	Music Videos	Magazines
Set Media Products	• <i>Dove</i> (body care advert) • <i>River Island</i> (clothing advert) • <i>Shelter</i> (UK charity advert).	Learners must choose one video from list A: • <i>Corinne Bailey Rae – Stop Where You Are</i> • <i>Lil Nas X – SUN GOES DOWN</i> • <i>Emeli Sandé – Heaven</i> AND One video from list B: • <i>Suffjan Stevens – Sugar</i> • <i>Radiohead – Burn the Witch</i> • <i>David Guetta – Titanium</i>	<i>The Big Issue.</i>
Media Language	✓	✓	✓
Media Representations	✓	✓	✓
Media Contexts	Social and Cultural	Social and Cultural	Social, Cultural and Political

Advertising and Marketing: *Dove* (body care), *River Island* (clothing) and *Shelter* (charity)

Advertising and marketing must be studied in relation to media language and media representations, including a consideration of the social and cultural contexts that influence how media language is used to construct representations.

Learners must study **all three** set advertising and marketing products in this section.

The media products will be made available by OCR. Three contrasting posters have been selected.

Dove's 'Beautifully Real Moms' campaign from 2018 built on their ground-breaking and influential 'Real Beauty' campaign. Shot by Pulitzer prize-winning female photojournalists, the campaign sought to grow Dove's share of the baby care market by challenging media images of picture-perfect mothers.

River Island's 'Labels are for Clothes' campaign from 2018 was launched to mark the brand's thirtieth anniversary and generated significant media coverage for its inclusive approach focusing on models of varying race, body shapes and abilities. The campaign aimed to celebrate people who reject stereotypes and champion self-expression and has been hailed as a milestone in diversity in fashion advertising.

Shelter, the UK based housing and homelessness charity launched an advertising campaign in 2011 that was produced for those at risk of homelessness to point them to *Shelter's* free services and guide them to seek advice on issues around homelessness earlier.

Learners need to study the set advertising and marketing products in relation to **all** the subject content bullet points listed under the 'media language' and 'media representations' topics in the subject content table following the end of Component 02 to establish the codes and conventions of each category of advert.

Theories of media language and representation **do not** need to be studied.

Consideration should be made of media language elements specific to advertising and marketing such as locations, costumes, props, makeup, lighting, choice of camera shot, angle, typography, layout and address of written content to the audience.

Magazines: *The Big Issue*

Magazines must be studied in relation to media language and media representations, including a consideration of the social, cultural and political contexts that influence how media language is used to construct representations.

The Big Issue is a niche magazine outside the commercial mainstream that learners may not normally engage with. It provides a contrasting example of how the elements of the theoretical framework for media language can be used to construct alternative representations that appeal to particular audiences, including a consideration of the influence of the social, cultural and political contexts.

Learners must study **two front covers** of *The Big Issue*, from the September of the first year of teaching a two year course, (e.g. from September 2017 onwards for a candidate entering for assessment in June 2019), chosen by the centre. The front covers selected should demonstrate representations that are alternative to the mainstream and of national significance, in terms of the events or issues they portray.

Learners need to study the magazine products in relation to **all** the subject content bullet points listed under the 'media language' and 'media representations' topics in the subject content table at the end of Component 02.

Theories of media language and representation **do not** need to be studied.

Consideration should be made of media language elements specific to magazines such as locations, costumes, props, makeup, lighting, choice of camera shot, angle, typography, layout and address of written content to the audience.

The study of *The Big Issue* **does not** extend to online.

Music Videos: One pair of music videos

Music video must be studied in relation to media language and media representations, including a consideration of the social and cultural contexts that

influence how media language is used to construct representations.

For the study of music video, learners are required to

study **two** music videos.

Learners **must** study **one** music video from **List A AND one** music video from **List B** below:

List A	List B
<i>Corinne Bailey Rae – Stop Where You Are</i>	<i>Suffjan Stevens – Sugar</i>
<i>Lil Nas X – SUN GOES DOWN</i>	<i>Radiohead – Burn the Witch</i>
<i>Emeli Sandé – Heaven</i>	<i>David Guetta – Titanium</i>

Centres are free to choose any pairing from List A and List B.

The music videos are freely accessible via YouTube and Vimeo.

The music videos in List A all feature their respective artist(s) and are a mixture of performance and narrative, and raise a number of similar representational issues with a focus on the everyday.

The music videos in List B do not feature their respective artist(s) at all, instead, with each music video celebrating the power of narrative and a postmodern focus on visual signification. The videos in List B each use very different representations to each other, but each contrasts clearly with the representations featured in the music videos in list A.

Learners will explore the differences in media language and representation between examples from the two lists. All of the artists selected for both lists are well known, and the lists include a range of artists (considering both gender and ethnicity) and genres as well as ensuring that every music video on the list is age appropriate for an A level programme of study.

Theories of media language and representation **do not** need to be studied.

Learners should investigate how the elements of the theoretical framework for media language are used to construct representations that appeal to particular audiences, including a consideration of the influence of historical, social and cultural contexts. Consideration should be made of media language elements specific to music videos such as camera shots, angles, lighting, settings, locations, costumes, props, makeup, editing and sound as appropriate.